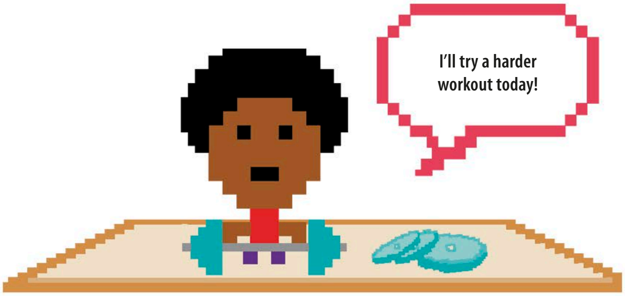
2 **Test the code**
Run the program to check if this change works. You should see this message appear in the shell window.

```
Choose difficulty (type 1, 2, or 3):
 1 Easy
 2 Normal
 3 Hard
```

3 **Set the levels**
Now use `if`, `elif`, and `else` statements to set the number of lives for each level. Try using 12 lives for easy, 9 for normal, and 6 for hard. If you're not happy with how easy or hard the levels are, you can change the number of lives after you've tested them out. Add this code after the lines that ask the player to choose a level.

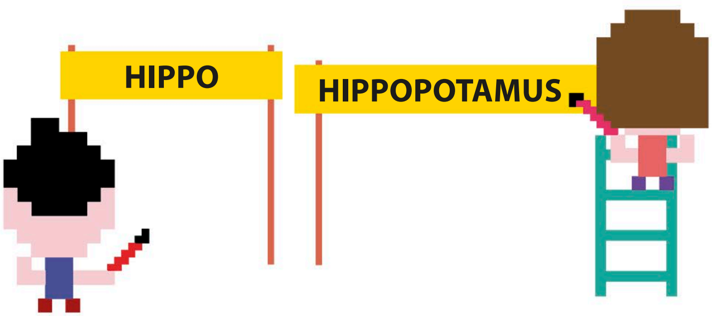



```
difficulty = input('Choose difficulty (type 1, 2 or 3):\n 1 Easy\n 2 Normal\n 3 Hard\n')
difficulty = int(difficulty)

if difficulty == 1:
    lives = 12
elif difficulty == 2:
    lives = 9
else:
    lives = 6
```

Words of varying length

What if you want to play a game with varying word lengths? If you don't know the length of the secret word before the program is run, you won't know how long to make the list to hold the clue. There's a clever fix you can use to solve this problem.



1 **Use an empty list**
When you create the list that holds the clue, don't fill it with question marks – just leave the list empty. Make this change to the `clue` list.

```
clue = []
```

There's nothing inside the brackets.